ALI ALJAFFER

Platform Engineer
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | +966 54 523 7822 | ali.h.aljaffer@gmail.com | linkedin/alialjaffer | github/aliAljaffer | alialjaffer.com

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Alibaba Cloud, Google Cloud (GCP), Amazon Web Services (AWS)
OS & Containers: Linux, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Kustomize, Rancher, KServe, vLLM, cert-manager
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, Terragrunt, Ansible
Security: Trivy, Hashicorp Vault, Kyverno, External Secrets, OpenZiti, Hoop.dev
CI/CD & GitOps: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, ArgoCD, Tekton, Azure Pipelines
Observability & Reliability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Thanos, Alertmanager, ELK Stack
Programming & Scripting: Bash, Python, Go, TypeScript

WORK EXPERIENCE

Platform Engineer — Saudi Azm, Riyadh — Feb. 2026 – Present

- Own cloud infrastructure for 3+ production PPP projects (100K+ users, 40+ multi-AZ resources, 80K SAR/mo) as sole author of 4+ Terragrunt repos, cutting provisioning from 3 days to under 3 hours via reusable modules, incl. a full prod stack in a new Alibaba tenant (ACK, RDS+PITR, Redis, ALB, SLS, ACR)
- Operate GitOps delivery for 10+ projects across multiple Alibaba ACK clusters via ArgoCD
- Quadrupled Trivy scan coverage (to 93% of deployable repos) via blocking CI gates and a daily automated audit, resulting in near-immediate response time to CRITICAL CVEs (incl. php2shell,node2shell; CVSS 9.2)
- Engineered a self-service, secure-access pipeline (OpenVPN) that emails short-lived configs, cutting per-user setup from 15 minutes to under 30 seconds
- Migrated AI workloads from plain Kubernetes deployments to KServe via reusable Kustomize framework, onboarding a new GPU client end-to-end in under 30 minutes

DevOps Intern — Manafa Crowdfunding, Riyadh — Jan. 2026

- Set up a Datastream pipeline from MySQL to BigQuery over Private Service Connect, enabling real-time analytics

SIDE PROJECTS

openziti-operator — Open-Source Kubernetes Operator — Sep. 2026 – Present

- Built a Go Kubernetes operator for OpenZiti (15 CRDs) that publishes apps, enrolls identities, and runs routers from YAML, shipped as a Helm chart on GHCR, with multiple releases covering unit, e2e, and security CI

Bare-Metal Kubernetes Homelab — Personal Project — Nov. 2025 – Present

- Operate a five-node bare-metal Kubernetes cluster on Talos Linux, fully GitOps-managed with ArgoCD: Cilium with Gateway API and default-deny network policies, Keycloak SSO, Falco, Longhorn DR backups to GCS, and Prometheus/Thanos/Loki observability

DevOps Educational YouTube Channel — Content Creator — Aug. 2025 – Present

- Produce DevOps and cloud tutorials in Arabic and English, with 30+ videos on YouTube

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, with Minor in Mathematics — May 2024
Wright State University, Ohio, United States — GPA: 4.0/4.0

CERTIFICATIONS

Professional Cloud Security Engineer, Google Cloud Platform — Oct. 2026
Professional Cloud Architect, Google Cloud Platform — May 2026
CNCF Kubestronaut (CKA, CKAD, CKS), Linux Foundation — Feb. 2026
Terraform Associate, HashiCorp — Aug. 2025
Solutions Architect – Associate, Amazon Web Services — Jul. 2025